

Jogeshwari Travel Knowledge Base

Historical & Heritage Sites

- **Jogeshwari Caves:** A 6th-century rock-cut cave complex dedicated to Lord Shiva. It is one of the earliest examples of Hindu cave architecture in India, older than the Elephanta Caves.
- **Mahakali Caves:** Also known as Kondivite Caves, these are 19 rock-cut Buddhist monuments built between the 1st century BCE and 6th century CE.
- **Kanheri Caves:** Located inside SGNP, this massive site contains 109 Buddhist caves and served as a major center for Buddhist learning for over 1,000 years.
- **Gilbert Hill:** A rare 66-million-year-old basalt monolith. It is a National Geological Monument and one of only three such structures in the world.
- **Madh Fort:** A small but strategic watchtower built by the Portuguese in the 17th century, offering a panoramic view of the coastline.
- **Versova Fort:** Also known as Madh Island Fort, it was a key military outpost during the Maratha-Portuguese wars.
- **Bandra Fort:** Built by the Portuguese in 1640 as a watchtower (Castella de Aguada) to guard the northern sea route into Mumbai.

Nature & Outdoors

- **Sanjay Gandhi National Park (SGNP):** One of the world's most visited national parks within a city. It is home to leopards, deer, and the famous tiger safari.
- **Aarey Colony:** Known as the "Green Lung" of Mumbai, it is an extension of the forest area featuring milk colonies, gardens, and diverse birdlife.
- **Chhota Kashmir:** A peaceful garden and lake in Aarey Colony, popular for boating and its resemblance to the landscapes of Kashmir.
- **Powai Lake:** An artificial lake built in 1891. The promenade is famous for sunset views and spotting crocodiles.
- **Mindspace Garden:** A modern urban park in Malad designed for evening walks and recreation amidst the business district.

- **Ashok Kamte Park:** A local community park named after a 26/11 martyr, providing a quiet green space in Jogeshwari East.

Beaches & Waterfronts

- **Juhu Beach:** Mumbai's most iconic beach, famous for its street food (Pav Bhaji/Gola) and being the residential hub of Bollywood stars.
- **Versova Beach:** Known for its fishing community and one of the largest citizen-led beach cleanup projects in the world.
- **Aksa Beach:** A clean, scenic beach in Malad known for its strong currents and quiet atmosphere compared to Juhu.

Shopping & Entertainment

- **Oberoi Mall:** A major eco-friendly shopping destination in Goregaon East, known for international brands and its large food court.
- **Infiniti Mall:** A premium mall in Andheri West featuring an indoor roller coaster and a large cinema complex.
- **Inorbit Mall:** One of the oldest high-end malls in Malad, a pioneer in the "lifestyle mall" concept in Mumbai.
- **Film City:** The heart of Bollywood. It features thousands of acres of land with permanent sets of villages, temples, and city streets.
- **NESCO Center:** A massive exhibition and convention center that hosts major international trade fairs and music concerts.
- **Snow World:** An indoor theme park in Kurla (Phoenix Marketcity) where you can experience sub-zero temperatures and snow activities.

Culture & Religious Landmarks

- **Global Vipassana Pagoda:** A monument of peace and harmony modeled after the Shwedagon Pagoda. It holds the world's largest stone dome.
- **ISKCON Temple:** A beautiful marble temple dedicated to Lord Krishna, famous for its evening *aartis* and spiritual atmosphere.
- **Prithvi Theatre:** Built by Shashi Kapoor in memory of Prithviraj Kapoor, it is India's most legendary venue for live Hindi theatre.

1. Jogeshwari Caves

- **History:** Dating back to **520–550 CE**, these are some of the earliest Hindu cave temples in India. They were carved during the same era as the Ajanta and Elephanta Caves.
- **Significance:** Dedicated to **Lord Shiva** and the goddess **Jogeshwari** (the clan deity for many local communities).
- **Architecture:** Features a large hall with 20 pillars and intricate carvings of Shiva in various forms (Natasha, Lakulisha).

2. Mahakali Caves (Kondivite Caves)

- **History:** Built between the **1st century BCE and 6th century CE**, this complex consists of 19 rock-cut Buddhist monuments.
- **Significance:** Most caves are *Viharas* (monasteries for monks), but Cave 9 is a *Chaitya* (prayer hall) containing Buddhist stupas and sculptures of the Buddha.

3. Sanjay Gandhi National Park (SGNP)

- **History:** Established in **1969**, it is one of the very few national parks located within city limits. It was formerly known as Borivali National Park.
- **Significance:** It serves as the "lungs of Mumbai." It contains the 2000-year-old Kanheri Caves and a famous Tiger & Lion Safari.

4. Chhota Kashmir

- **History:** Located in Aarey Colony, this spot was developed to give Mumbaikars a feel of Kashmir's greenery and lakes.
- **Significance:** Famous for its **boating lake** and for being a prime location for 1970s Bollywood film shoots.

5. Juhu Beach

- **History:** Juhu was an island in the 19th century. In the 1930s, Juhu became famous as the site of India's first civil aviation airport (Juhu Aerodrome).
- **Significance:** One of the most famous beaches in India. It is home to many Bollywood celebrities like Amitabh Bachchan.

6. Oberoi Mall

- **History:** Opened in **2008**, it was one of the first malls in Mumbai to focus on an "environmental-friendly" design (LEED Gold certified).
- **Significance:** A major landmark in Goregaon East for shopping and entertainment.

7. Film City (Dadasaheb Phalke Chitranagari)

- **History:** Built in **1977** by the state government to provide facilities to the film industry.

- **Significance:** It has over 42 outdoor shooting locations and 16 studios. Most Bollywood movies and TV serials are filmed here.

8. Gilbert Hill

- **History:** A **66-million-year-old** monolith of black basalt rock. It was formed by molten lava during the Mesozoic Era.
- **Significance:** It is one of only three such volcanic rock outcrops in the entire world (the others are in the USA). It has a Gaodevi temple at the top.

9. Kanheri Caves

- **History:** A massive Buddhist university carved into the hills between the **1st century BCE and 10th century CE**.
- **Significance:** Contains **109 caves**. It shows the transition of Buddhism from Hinayana to Mahayana through its sculptures and inscriptions.

10. Global Vipassana Pagoda

- **History:** Inaugurated in **2009** by Pratibha Patil. It is modeled after the Shwedagon Pagoda in Myanmar.
- **Significance:** The world's largest stone dome built without any supporting pillars. It can hold 8,000 meditators.

11. Prithvi Theatre

- **History:** Founded in **1944** by **Prithviraj Kapoor** as a traveling troupe. The current permanent building in Juhu was built by **Shashi Kapoor** in 1978.
- **Significance:** The "Temple of Hindi Theatre." It is a non-profit space dedicated to live performing arts.

12. Bandra Fort (Castella de Aguada)

- **History:** Built by the **Portuguese in 1640** as a watchtower overlooking the Mahim Bay.
- **Significance:** Its name means "Fort of the Water Point" because it was used to provide fresh water to Portuguese ships.